

conscious decision to share part of it with you. Although this money is usually readily accepted, it is usually not truly appreciated. Don't forget the earlier lesson that money received that is not earned is money that does not hold as much value.

Tim received these shares of stock upon his eighteenth birthday. Unfortunately, he found there was no owner's manual accompanying this gift of stock. Since Tim was of legal age and the stocks were in his name, he had complete control over them. With access to all this money, Tim decided to drop out of college (which he didn't see as necessary) and start his own business. He was anxious to become even richer and his new-found wealth gave him a sense of bravado. Tim ended up purchasing a fast food franchise whose down payment depleted almost all of the value of his stocks.

With little expertise in running a business (other than a business class he took in high school) and very little money in reserve, Tim had problems from the beginning. At the outset, Tim had not perceived college to be worthwhile, but now he wondered if he had made a mistake. Tim was wishing he had had the benefit of taking classes in accounting, economics, advertising, and entrepreneurship.

A novice businessman, Tim made numerous uninformed decisions. For instance, he didn't realize that it could take years for a small business to turn a profit. As a result, Tim failed to plan for expected losses.

Less than a year later, the money that his dad had worked so hard to save for Tim's future was completely gone. Tim's business both opened and closed its doors in the same year. Eighteen years of consistent saving had been an important commitment for Tim's father, but he did not mind making the sacrifice. This money was to have provided Tim with a security blanket to last throughout his life.

